

Customer Segment Analysis

Updated for the Current Aryze Product Suite

Executive Summary

Aryze's current product suite serves three primary customer segments through three distinct product routes:

- 1. **UK merchants and payment-driven businesses** through **Pay by Bank**
- 2. **Builders, technical teams, innovation teams, product teams, and exploratory operators** through **Stablecoin Factory**
- 3. **Already-licensed institutions operating digital money** through **Digital Cash**

The suite is focused on making money more usable across three commercial environments: direct bank payments, simple stablecoin deployment, and full institutional digital cash infrastructure.

The strongest near-term commercial segment remains **UK merchants and payment-driven businesses**. The problem is concrete, commercially urgent, and close to margin: businesses want faster settlement, lower payment friction, stronger operational control, and better payment economics. Pay by Bank is therefore the clearest immediate commercial fit.

The strongest institutional segment is **already-licensed institutions operating digital money**. These customers need more than simple issuance. They need a full operating layer that can support settlement, ramps, treasury, multi-currency issuance, interoperability, and asset movement in real financial environments. Digital Cash is the correct fit for this segment.

The third core segment is **builders, technical teams, innovation teams, product teams, and exploratory operators**. This segment has a clear and strong need for a faster, more usable way to move from stablecoin concept to simple live deployment. Stablecoin Factory is the right fit because it reduces friction, supports self-serve deployment, and gives teams a practical entry point before they need full institutional operating depth.

Overall Segment Assessment

Customer Segment	Primary Product Fit	Evidence Strength	Commercial Priority Now	Rationale
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UK merchants and payment-driven businesses	Pay by Bank	High	1	Clear commercial pain, strong payment-performance need, short path from problem to buying conversation
Already-licensed institutions operating digital money	Digital Cash	High	2	Strong institutional need, high-value use cases, but heavier buying committees and longer sales cycles
Builders, technical teams, innovation teams, product teams, and exploratory operators	Stablecoin Factory	High	3	Clear need for low-friction stablecoin deployment, strong technical relevance, and a practical self-serve entry point

The ranking reflects go-to-market priority now. It does not mean one product is strategically more important forever. Pay by Bank is the most immediately actionable revenue motion. Digital Cash is the strongest enterprise infrastructure opportunity. Stablecoin Factory is the clearest scalable entry product for simple stablecoin deployment and future expansion into deeper infrastructure needs.

Product-to-Segment Architecture

Pay by Bank

Segment served: UK merchants and payment-driven businesses

Pay by Bank serves businesses that need a better way to get paid. These customers care about payment efficiency, settlement speed, payment economics, and operational control. The strongest near-term fit is with UK merchants in gaming, betting, trading, and other higher-risk or card-under-served verticals where payment performance has a direct commercial impact.

Stablecoin Factory

Segment served: Builders, technical teams, innovation teams, product teams, and exploratory operators

Stablecoin Factory serves teams that want a fast, self-serve, low-friction route to launching a simple stablecoin. These customers want to move from concept to live deployment without starting with a long enterprise process or a full custom infrastructure build. They value speed, usability, experimentation, and learning through real deployment.

Digital Cash

Segment served: Already-licensed institutions operating digital money

Digital Cash serves already-licensed institutions that want to issue and operate their own digital cash programme under their own licence and control. These customers need the full operational layer behind issuance, including settlement, ramps, treasury, multi-currency issuance, interoperability, and asset movement across real financial environments.

Segment 1: UK Merchants and Payment-Driven Businesses

Product Fit: Pay by Bank

Segment Definition

This segment consists of UK merchants and payment-driven businesses where incoming payments materially affect margin, settlement, customer experience, fraud exposure, reconciliation, and day-to-day operations.

These businesses do not treat payments as a minor back-office function. Payments are part of their operating model. If the payment flow is expensive, slow, fragmented, or hard to control, it affects the business commercially.

The strongest near-term fit is with gaming, betting, trading, and other higher-risk or card-under-served verticals. These businesses often face higher friction, weaker card economics, elevated chargeback exposure, or operational pain around payment flows. Over time, the segment can also extend into wallets, remittance, and e-commerce where payment performance is commercially significant.

What This Customer Wants

This customer wants a faster, cheaper, cleaner, and more controllable way to get paid.

They want to move money from customer to merchant more directly. They want settlement to happen faster. They want less friction in the payment journey. They want stronger operational visibility. They want fewer problems around refunds, disputes, reconciliation, and payment status.

The core customer need is simple:

Get paid more efficiently with better control.

Why This Segment Matters

This segment is commercially attractive because the pain is close to revenue, margin, and operations. A merchant does not need a theoretical argument to care about payments. If payment costs are too high, settlement is too slow, or refunds and reconciliation are too messy, the business impact is immediate.

Pay by Bank has strong fit because it gives these businesses a more direct account-to-account payment rail. It is not positioned as “just another payment method.” It is positioned as a better payment flow for businesses where payment performance matters.

Best-Fit Customer Profile

The best-fit Pay by Bank customer is a UK merchant or payment-driven business that:

- has meaningful incoming payment volume
- operates in a vertical where card payments are expensive, fragile, or poorly suited
- cares about settlement speed and payment efficiency
- experiences friction around refunds, reconciliation, chargebacks, or payment operations
- wants stronger control over how money moves into the business
- has the internal ability to evaluate and implement a new payment rail

The strongest current sub-segments are:

- gaming businesses
- betting platforms
- trading platforms
- high-risk or card-under-served merchants
- merchants with elevated chargeback exposure
- payment-heavy businesses where faster settlement improves operations

Typical Buyer Titles and Buying Committee

The buying committee will usually include:

- CFO or Finance Director
- Treasurer
- Head of Payments
- Payments Product Manager

- VP E-commerce
- Product Lead
- Head of Fraud or Risk
- Operations Lead
- ERP or finance systems owner
- CTO or engineering lead

The economic owner is often finance. The functional owner is often payments. Product or e-commerce may care about the checkout experience. Risk and fraud teams care about disputes and exposure. Engineering matters because the solution must be implemented properly.

Buying Triggers

Common buying triggers include:

- card-acquiring costs are too high
- settlement is too slow
- chargeback exposure is too high
- refund handling is operationally painful
- reconciliation takes too much manual effort
- payment status visibility is weak
- the current payment journey is too dependent on card rails
- the business needs a more direct way to move funds from customer to merchant

The clearest trigger is when payment performance becomes a visible business problem rather than a hidden operating cost.

Regulatory and Operational Constraints

The main constraints are:

- UK-only commercial scope for now
- customer journey design
- bank coverage
- open-banking authorisation flow
- refund handling
- payment status callbacks
- settlement reporting
- operational reconciliation
- integration into existing finance or payment systems

Pay by Bank should not be positioned outside the UK until the relevant licensing position supports it. The UK scope is part of the current commercial discipline.

Technical and Integration Requirements

Typical requirements include:

- account-to-account payment initiation
- open-banking flow integration
- checkout or deposit-flow integration
- bank authorisation journey
- payment status callbacks or webhooks
- refund flow handling
- reporting and reconciliation
- ERP or accounting system mapping
- operational dashboard access
- support for payment monitoring and merchant operations

For many merchants, technical integration is not the main reason to buy, but it is a key reason deals can slow down. The product must feel operationally usable, not just commercially attractive.

Top Pains

1. **Payment costs are too high**
The business loses too much margin in the process of getting paid.
2. **Settlement is too slow**
Funds do not arrive quickly enough to support cash flow, liquidity, or operational needs.
3. **Refunds and reconciliation create too much work**
Payment operations require manual effort, fragmented reporting, and unnecessary operational attention.
4. **Fraud, disputes, and chargebacks create ongoing burden**
Even when manageable, they add cost, risk, and operational complexity.
5. **The payment flow is too indirect and hard to control**
The business lacks sufficient control over how money moves from customer payment to final settlement.

Top Desired Gains

1. Lower payment acceptance cost
2. Faster settlement
3. Cleaner reconciliation
4. Lower dispute and chargeback burden
5. More direct control over payment flow and cash visibility

Primary Product Fit

Pay by Bank is the correct product fit.

It gives UK merchants and payment-driven businesses a direct account-to-account payment rail that improves settlement speed, reduces friction, and gives stronger operational control than traditional card-based flows.

Sales Discovery Questions

- How much of your payment cost is currently driven by cards, disputes, refunds, and reconciliation?
- Where does settlement speed create operational or cash-flow pressure today?
- Which payment flows are most painful: deposits, top-ups, refunds, recurring payments, high-value payments, or mobile checkout?
- How much internal work is created by payment reporting and reconciliation?
- What would need to be true for you to shift meaningful volume away from card rails?

Segment Conclusion

This is the most immediately actionable commercial segment. The pain is clear, the product fit is direct, and the buying conversation is practical. Pay by Bank should be positioned as a better way for UK merchants to get paid: faster, with lower friction, and with stronger control.

Segment 2: Already-Licensed Institutions Operating Digital Money

Product Fit: Digital Cash

Segment Definition

This segment consists of already-licensed institutions that want to issue and operate digital cash under their own licence, governance, and control.

This includes banks, financial institutions, fintech clusters, licensed conglomerates, and other regulated operators that need more than simple issuance. These customers are not looking for a token demo. They need a real operating layer for digital cash in live financial environments.

The strongest fit is with institutions that need settlement, ramps, treasury, multi-currency issuance, interoperability, and asset movement as part of a broader institutional digital cash model.

What This Customer Wants

This customer wants to operate digital cash in a serious, controlled, institution-ready way.

They want to issue under their own licence. They want to retain control. They want infrastructure that can fit inside real financial operations. They need digital cash to work across settlement, treasury, liquidity, ramps, and value movement.

The core customer need is:

Operate digital cash under their own licence with full institutional infrastructure behind it.

Why This Segment Matters

This segment is strategically important because institutional digital money is no longer only theoretical. Banks, regulated institutions, and financial infrastructure players are exploring tokenised deposits, stablecoins, settlement assets, and digital cash models because existing rails do not fully solve the need for programmable, interoperable, and continuously available money movement.

However, institutional adoption depends on more than the ability to issue an asset. The hard part is making digital cash work inside real operating environments.

That is why Digital Cash is not just an issuance product. It is the full institutional operating layer.

Best-Fit Customer Profile

The best-fit Digital Cash customer is an already-licensed institution that:

- wants to issue digital cash under its own licence
- has a concrete use case beyond experimentation
- needs operational depth, not only simple issuance
- requires settlement, ramps, treasury, multi-currency issuance, interoperability, or asset movement
- does not want to build the full infrastructure stack internally
- has the internal maturity to evaluate legal, compliance, treasury, technology, and operational requirements
- wants a credible route from issuance to live operation

Strong-fit institution types include:

- banks running tokenised deposits
- banks managing intra-bank settlement
- clusters of fintechs clearing between themselves
- conglomerates with their own licences
- licensed financial institutions with treasury or settlement needs
- institutions that need controlled digital cash infrastructure for real financial use cases

Typical Buyer Titles and Buying Committee

The buying committee will usually include:

- Head of Treasury
- Head of Transaction Banking
- Head of Payments
- Digital Assets Lead
- CFO
- COO
- CIO or CTO
- Chief Compliance Officer
- MLRO
- General Counsel
- Risk Committee
- Senior Management or Executive Sponsor

The buying process is heavier than Pay by Bank because the product touches licensing, governance, treasury, compliance, technology, operations, and strategic infrastructure.

Buying Triggers

Common buying triggers include:

- need for treasury efficiency
- need for better internal settlement
- need for tokenised deposit infrastructure
- need for 24/7 value movement
- need for cross-border liquidity improvement
- need for digital cash infrastructure under the institution's own licence
- desire to move from pilot or concept into live operation
- pressure to avoid building the full infrastructure stack internally

The strongest trigger is when the institution has a real operating use case and recognises that simple issuance is not enough.

Regulatory and Operational Constraints

The main constraints include:

- licence scope
- legal classification
- issuer responsibility
- governance model
- reserve and liquidity structure
- AML and sanctions controls
- compliance requirements
- ICT and third-party risk
- operational resilience
- auditability
- settlement finality
- interoperability with existing rails
- internal risk and management approval

Digital Cash must always be positioned as infrastructure. Aryze does not become the issuer. The customer issues under its own licence.

Technical and Integration Requirements

Typical requirements include:

- issuer logic
- mint and burn controls
- settlement infrastructure
- treasury functionality
- on and off ramps
- multi-currency issuance
- asset movement across environments
- wallet or custody integration
- compliance and sanctions controls
- audit trails
- 24/7 operational capability
- core banking integration
- ERP or treasury system integration
- interoperability with bank, payment, or ledger environments

This customer does not need a lightweight product. It needs infrastructure that can survive institutional scrutiny and real-world operation.

Top Pains

1. **Simple issuance is not enough**
Launching a token does not solve settlement, treasury, ramps, interoperability, or operational control.
2. **Building the full stack internally is too heavy**
Internal development is slow, expensive, complex, and hard to coordinate across functions.
3. **Governance and compliance requirements are demanding**
Digital cash cannot move forward unless legal, compliance, risk, and management teams can support the model.
4. **Integration with existing financial infrastructure is difficult**
Digital cash must work with treasury, banking systems, settlement flows, wallets, and operational controls.
5. **The institution needs control without unnecessary infrastructure burden**
They want to remain the issuer and operator, but they do not want to build every component themselves.

Top Desired Gains

1. Controlled issuance under the institution's own licence
2. Full operational infrastructure behind digital cash
3. Better treasury, settlement, and liquidity capability
4. Lower infrastructure burden
5. A clearer route from issuance to live operation

Primary Product Fit

Digital Cash is the correct product fit.

It provides enterprise infrastructure for already-licensed institutions that want to issue and operate their own digital cash programme with settlement, ramps, treasury, multi-currency issuance, interoperability, and asset movement.

Sales Discovery Questions

- What concrete use case is driving this: treasury, settlement, internal value movement, tokenised deposits, or cross-border liquidity?
- What licence or permission will the programme operate under?
- What operational layer is missing today between issuance and real usage?
- Which internal functions would need to approve the model?

- Which capabilities matter most: settlement, ramps, treasury, multi-currency issuance, interoperability, or asset movement?

Segment Conclusion

This is the strongest enterprise infrastructure segment. The buying process is heavier, but the value is deeper. Digital Cash should be positioned as the full institutional infrastructure layer for already-licensed organisations that want to issue and operate digital cash in real financial environments.

Segment 3: Builders, Technical Teams, Innovation Teams, Product Teams, and Exploratory Operators

Product Fit: Stablecoin Factory

Segment Definition

This segment consists of builders, technical teams, innovation teams, product teams, technical founders, and exploratory operators that want a faster and easier way to launch a simple stablecoin.

They are not yet necessarily ready for a full institutional operating layer. They may not need settlement, ramps, treasury, and multi-currency infrastructure from day one. Their immediate need is a practical entry point that helps them move from concept to live deployment with less friction.

Stablecoin Factory serves this segment by making simple stablecoin deployment more accessible, more usable, and faster to start.

What This Customer Wants

This customer wants to move quickly.

They want to test a stablecoin use case without spending months assembling infrastructure. They want a simple deployment path. They want to avoid unnecessary custom build work at the

beginning. They want to learn through real usage rather than stay stuck in concept, design, or internal discussion.

The core customer need is:

Launch a simple stablecoin faster through a self-serve, low-friction deployment model.

Why This Segment Matters

This segment is important because the gap between stablecoin interest and stablecoin deployment remains large. Many teams can identify a use case. Far fewer can get from idea to live issuance quickly and cleanly.

The need is strong because stablecoin deployment is still too heavy for many teams. It often requires too much custom build work, too much infrastructure coordination, and too much enterprise complexity too early in the process.

Stablecoin Factory is valuable because it creates a practical starting point. It gives teams a way to deploy, test, learn, and decide whether the use case needs to grow into a deeper operating model later.

Evidence Strength

The evidence strength for this segment is **High**.

The market signal is strong because stablecoin infrastructure is becoming more relevant across finance, fintech, enterprise, and digital asset ecosystems. The practical problem is also clear: teams need a faster way to move from stablecoin concept to live setup.

The product fit is strong because Stablecoin Factory directly addresses the deployment gap. It reduces friction, shortens the path to launch, and gives teams a self-serve way to begin without starting with full institutional complexity.

Best-Fit Customer Profile

The best-fit Stablecoin Factory customer is a team that:

- has a stablecoin idea or use case
- wants to move from concept to live deployment
- values speed and low friction
- prefers self-serve deployment over a long enterprise process
- does not need a full institutional operating layer from day one
- wants to test and learn through real usage
- has enough technical maturity to understand what it is launching

- may later expand into deeper infrastructure if the use case matures

Strong-fit customer types include:

- technical founders
- product teams
- innovation teams
- fintech builders
- Web3 or digital asset teams
- exploratory operators
- internal venture or innovation units
- teams testing stablecoin-based product concepts

Typical Buyer Titles and Buying Committee

The buying committee will usually be lighter than Digital Cash and more product or technical than Pay by Bank.

Typical stakeholders include:

- Founder
- CTO
- VP Engineering
- Product Lead
- Head of Innovation
- Digital Assets Lead
- Technical Lead
- Platform Lead
- Principal Architect

In early-stage or exploratory teams, the buyer may be very close to the builder. In larger organisations, the buyer may sit in innovation, product, digital assets, or platform strategy.

Buying Triggers

Common buying triggers include:

- the team has a stablecoin idea but no simple way to launch it
- the current path to deployment feels too slow or too complex
- internal momentum is blocked by infrastructure uncertainty
- the team wants to test with a live setup instead of only discussing the concept
- custom build work feels too heavy for the current maturity of the use case
- the team wants a low-friction route before committing to enterprise infrastructure
- the team wants a self-serve deployment experience

The strongest trigger is when the team wants to learn through live deployment, but the existing path is too slow or fragmented.

Regulatory and Operational Constraints

The main constraints include:

- uncertainty around what the stablecoin will be used for
- unclear legal or regulatory classification as the use case matures
- limited internal capacity for custom build work
- need for clarity around what self-serve deployment does and does not cover
- need to understand when simple issuance is no longer enough
- need to know when the use case should move toward Digital Cash or a deeper operating layer

Stablecoin Factory is strongest when the customer needs simple deployment. If the customer already requires settlement, treasury, ramps, multi-currency issuance, and institutional operations, the better fit may be Digital Cash.

Technical and Integration Requirements

Typical requirements include:

- simple stablecoin deployment flow
- self-serve product experience
- AI-native deployment support
- basic issuance functionality
- usable setup process
- ability to test and learn quickly
- clear upgrade path if the use case becomes more complex
- sufficient documentation or guidance to support technical users

The product must feel lightweight enough to start quickly, but serious enough that builders trust the deployment path.

Top Pains

1. **The path from idea to live deployment is too heavy**
Teams can identify the use case, but launching it takes too much time and effort.
2. **There is too much custom build work too early**
Teams do not want to assemble infrastructure from scratch before they have validated the use case.

3. **Stablecoin deployment feels fragmented**
The process often involves too many separate decisions, components, and technical dependencies.
4. **Enterprise complexity appears too early**
Many teams want to start simple before taking on settlement, treasury, ramps, and institutional operating depth.
5. **There is no clear entry point**
Teams need a practical starting point that lets them deploy, test, and learn.

Top Desired Gains

1. Faster path from concept to live deployment
2. Lower deployment friction
3. Self-serve setup
4. Ability to learn through real use
5. A simple entry point that can grow into deeper infrastructure later

Primary Product Fit

Stablecoin Factory is the correct product fit.

It gives builders, technical teams, innovation teams, product teams, and exploratory operators a faster, AI-native, self-serve way to launch a simple stablecoin without starting with full enterprise complexity.

Sales Discovery Questions

- What stablecoin use case are you trying to test or launch?
- Is your immediate need simple issuance, or do you already need a full operating layer?
- What is slowing you down today: technical setup, internal uncertainty, infrastructure complexity, or regulatory questions?
- How quickly do you need to move from concept to live deployment?
- If the use case works, what capabilities would you need next?

Segment Conclusion

This is a high-evidence segment with a strong product fit. The need is clear: teams want to launch simple stablecoins faster and with less friction. Stablecoin Factory should be positioned as the low-friction entry point for stablecoin deployment, giving teams a practical way to move from idea to live setup and learn through real use.

Final Strategic Conclusion

Aryze’s current customer segmentation should be organised around three primary segment-product fits.

Pay by Bank serves UK merchants and payment-driven businesses that need a faster, lower-friction, and more controllable way to get paid.

Stablecoin Factory serves builders, technical teams, innovation teams, product teams, and exploratory operators that need a fast, self-serve, low-friction way to launch a simple stablecoin.

Digital Cash serves already-licensed institutions that need a full operating layer for issuing and running digital cash under their own licence and control.

The clean commercial architecture is:

Product	Customer Segment	Core Customer Need
Pay by Bank	UK merchants and payment-driven businesses	Get paid faster, with less friction and more control
Stablecoin Factory	Builders, technical teams, innovation teams, product teams, and exploratory operators	Launch a simple stablecoin faster through self-serve deployment
Digital Cash	Already-licensed institutions	Operate digital cash with full institutional infrastructure

The most important strategic point is that the customer segmentation now follows the current product suite directly. Each product has a clear buyer type, a clear customer problem, and a distinct role in the commercial architecture.

Pay by Bank is the clearest near-term revenue motion. Digital Cash is the strongest enterprise infrastructure opportunity. Stablecoin Factory is the high-evidence entry product for stablecoin deployment and can create a scalable path from experimentation into deeper infrastructure demand.